

Up from the Cellar—Philadelphia Story

Quinn, Milwaukee Winner, Has Open Purse in Philly

(This is the first of two stories on the Philadelphia Phillies.)

By FRANK ECK

PHILADELPHIA (AP)—Things sure are different in the city of Brotherly Love this young baseball season.

When the campaign here began with a night game, park announcer Pete Byron blared this message over the public address system:

"Anybody interfering with the ball while it is in play will be taken from the park and executed."

Byron meant "prosecuted," but his warning led a fan to remark: "Boy, the Phillies are not fooling this spring."

The fan was referring to Philadelphia's managerial turnover — three managers for the first three games even before they had played their second.

Eddie Sawyer had blasted his players in Florida and when his ace, Robin Roberts, blew a four-run lead in the second inning of the first game in Cincinnati, he quit. "No more managing for me," he said.

Couldn't Make Opener

Then when general manager John Quinn decided the new manager would be Gene Mauch, who had made his mark at Atlanta and Minneapolis, Quinn learned that Mauch was in Florida, and couldn't make it for the opener. So Quinn appointed Andy Cohen, first base coach, as manager for the night.

"I waited 30 years to manage in the big leagues," said Cohen. "I just hope I don't blow this one chance."

He didn't. Cohen, famous as the second baseman who "replaced" Rogers Hornsby on the New York Giants, is the first manager to attain a perfect record managing the Phillies.

Baseball men expected third baseman Alvin Dark to become Quinn's manager when Sawyer bowed out. But Quinn had his eye on Mauch ever since 1953 when he suggested him to Earl Mann for the Atlanta job.

"Sawyer would still be with us," says Quinn, "but his mind was made up."

"As for Dark, I've told him when he steps down as a player

we will give him a job managing in our farm system. I just don't believe in naming a manager directly from the field. I know Bucky Harris, Lou Boudreau and Joe Cronin were successful playing managers, but there were a lot who weren't. One was Gabby Hartnett, a great catcher."

John Quinn is a baseball name that goes back to 1917 when his father ran the St. Louis Browns. His dad also was president of both Boston teams when the Back Bay had two teams.

Put Braves Together

"Young John" is 52. He put together an old club, the Boston Braves, for one shot and it won the 1948 pennant. When Lou Perini moved the seventh-place Braves to Milwaukee in 1953 Quinn went along. He rebuilt a team that won in 1957 and 1958 and just missed two others.

Quinn left Milwaukee a year ago January when Bob Carpenter, a duPont heir who owns the Phillies, asked him to replace Roy Hamey.

"Nevertheless," Quinn points out, "when Bob offered me a five-year contract it was too good to turn down. There is no limit as to what we can spend for talent. I also thought I owed it to my family." He has five children, two of whom help run minor league teams.

Poorest Showing

The Phillies won only 64 games in 1959, their poorest showing in 12 years. If they don't do better the 802,815 fans who turned out last year may hang a few people in effigy, or take announcer Byron's bloopers to heart.

Probably the worst deal the Phils made had Jack Sanford going to San Francisco for Rube Gomez. Sanford won 12 last year,



John Quinn, right, was so enthused about getting Gene Mauch to manage Philadelphia's baseball team that he met 34-year-old pilot at airport. Quinn has had Mauch in mind since 1953. Mauch turned down Kansas City job last winter.

Gomez three. Another clinker saw the Dodgers stick the Phils with second baseman Sparky Anderson, now back in Toronto. These deals were made before Quinn.

Since Quinn arrived he has dealt off five front line men, including Richie Ashburn. In their place he has 18 new faces, including basketball star Gene Conley, a fine pitcher, and a flock of rookies.

Rookie Slugger

One rookie slugger is Pancho Herrera, who never played second base until spring training. Sawyer said he is "the best second baseman the Phillies had in 17 years and that it took him three weeks to prove it." Neither Quinn nor Mauch agree on this. Lately Herrera, who is 6-feet-3, has been playing first base.

"These new men should help us," says Quinn. "We got a better farm system then we had in Boston. We are tied up with Buffalo and Indianapolis. So there is reason to hope. This town is one of the best in baseball. Fan enthusiasm is great."

"Two boys who will make it for the future are Ray Culp, 18, from Austin, Tex., and Al Neiger, 21, from Wilmington, Del. (Culp is a \$100,000 bonus boy). Both are exceptional pitchers and are in the minors for experience."

"I had a chance to go with the Yankees under George Weiss just before I came here. I'm glad I came. There's a lot of work to be done."

Next: Gene Mauch, the baby-faced manager.